The Spell Taught by Mañjuśrī

Toh 893 · Derge Kangyur

Toh 893 in the Kangyur is a short spell text centered on the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī. Its full English, Sanskrit, and Tibetan titles cannot be confirmed from the opening lines alone. After homage to the Three Jewels and to the Gentle Protector, Mañjuśrī in his youthful form rises before the Blessed One and the assembled gathering and offers to reveal a supreme spell, or vidyā, which he says will be a wonder when spoken. The assembly applauds him, and with the Buddha's approval he pays homage to all phenomena and to the essence of all the buddhas before proclaiming the spell. As a work devoted to presenting a sacred incantation for recitation, it belongs to the dhāraṇī class of texts, which the Kangyur gathers in its collection of dhāraṇīs.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the Gentle Protector (Mañjunātha).

Then Mañjuśrī, who had become a youth, rose once more from his seat. He draped his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, and bowed with his palms joined toward where the Blessed One was. He bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I shall make a spell (vidyā) manifest. When this supreme spell is spoken, it will be a wonder."

That whole assembly gave the bodhisattva, the great being Mañjuśrī, their "Excellent!", saying: "Mañjuśrī, excellent, excellent! Mañjuśrī, speak the spell!"

"By the word of the Blessed One I shall speak it."

The bodhisattva, the great being Mañjuśrī, paid homage to all phenomena, the essence of all the buddhas, made offerings, and spoke the spell:

namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ namo mañjuśriye bodhisatvāya oṃ mañju para mañju ghoṣa hana hana paca paca mata mata matha matha vidhvansaya vidhvansaya kara kara truṭa truṭa bañja bañja abhisa abhisa tuṭa tuṭa truṭa truṭa sphuṭa sphuṭa hṛdaya baṃdhani namaḥ saṃbodhani prabhesa prabhesa lota lota kṛda kṛda kṛṭa kṛṭa hasa hasa prabandha prabandha āviśa āviśa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā

Whoever recites it three times at midnight, and also recites it seven times during the day, will obtain great knowledge. Such a person will retain three hundred ślokas of human composition.

Its rite is this: one makes a maṇḍala with sandalwood and also makes offerings with lamps of clarified butter. If one then recites it eight thousand times, it will be accomplished. Even if it is not accomplished, one will retain a hundred ślokas each day.

"Blessed One, if this which I have taught does not succeed, then, just like one who has committed the five acts of immediate retribution, I too shall have committed the five acts of immediate retribution."

This completes the dhāraṇī called The Oath Sworn by Noble Mañjuśrī.

Translator's Notes

• The text gives no explicit speaker for "By the word of the Blessed One I shall speak it." From context it is Mañjuśrī replying to the assembly. "Ślokas of human composition" renders "ślokas of humans," which seems to mean verses composed by people, as opposed to divine speech; the sense is not certain. The title term rendered "Oath" is a self-imprecation, a conditional curse on oneself, which matches Mañjuśrī's closing pledge.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.